

Caleb McCartney

Software Designer & Developer

Pittsburgh, PA | contact@mcc-cal.com | mccal.dev | github.com/McCal-Codes

SUMMARY

Designer and developer who ships whole products: Android apps in Kotlin and Jetpack Compose, desktop tools in TypeScript and Rust, and the small backends behind them. Background in photojournalism, so I care how software looks, reads and holds up under deadline. Current focus is Folio, an open-source Android launcher built for foldable screens.

SKILLS

Languages: Kotlin, TypeScript, Rust, Python, SQL, HTML/CSS

Platforms: Android (Jetpack Compose, WindowManager, adaptive layouts), React, Vite, Tauri, Cloudflare Workers, Vercel, Expo

Practice: UI and interaction design, performance profiling, Git/GitHub workflow and CI, release engineering, accessibility, writing documentation

Design: Figma, HTML mockup labs, Lightroom, Photoshop, Capture One

EXPERIENCE

McCal Media, Pittsburgh, PA

May 2024 - Present

Founder, Software Designer & Developer

- Design and build **Folio**, an open-source Android launcher for foldables, in Kotlin and Jetpack Compose (min SDK 31, target SDK 36). Layouts follow window size classes rather than device checks, so one interface carries across folded, unfolded and tablet screens. Public releases since September 2026.
- Cut time to a fully drawn Home screen from 899 ms to about 120 ms on a foldable, and the App Library from 824 ms to 317 ms, by measuring first, loading Home's own apps before the rest, and saving icons between starts.
- Designed an extension platform: a package format with a validator, an in-app Market for tweaks and page effects, and a rule that every feature works without root, with any root-only extras kept in a separate tier.
- Run the release pipeline: topic branches and pull requests with required checks, a VirusTotal scan and checksum per release, and a written explanation of every permission the app requests.
- Built the supporter-code service as a Cloudflare Worker with Ko-fi integration, and a Discord bot Worker for the community.
- Built **Keyd**, a companion Android keyboard, and **TerraNova**, an offline node-graph design studio for Hytale world generation (Tauri, TypeScript, Rust), released as alpha since March 2026.
- Freelance website and portfolio development in TypeScript, React and Vercel, including manifest-driven content and responsive image delivery.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Folio Android launcher for foldables. Kotlin, Compose. github.com/McCal-Codes

TerraNova Offline world-generation design studio. Tauri, TypeScript, Rust. LGPL-2.1, 4 stars.

Abridgd Finite local-news reader for iOS and Android. Prototype, work paused. See mccal.dev.

Folio Community Tweaks Signed tweak packages and a source template for Folio's Market. Python, GitHub Pages.

TerraNova Lab Online top-down visualizer for Hytale world-generation density graphs. TypeScript.

Void Ledger Local-first Warframe Baro Ki'Teer planning app for Windows. TypeScript.

PHOTOJOURNALISM & VISUAL STORYTELLING

Freelance photojournalist (Jan 2024 - Present) for TribLive, PublicSource, New York Post, Pittsburgh Magazine and Pittsburgh Union Progress. Keystone Media Award. Recent credits: TribLive (Sewickley Public Library, April 2026), nearly 50 stories and photographs for The Point Park Globe. Host of the Caffeinated Connections interview podcast.

Director of Visual Storytelling, McCal Media (Sept 2020 - Present). Client-facing photo and storytelling work across more than 25 projects. Portfolio at mcc-cal.com.

EDUCATION

Point Park University, Pittsburgh, PA

Aug 2021 - Aug 2025

BFA, Photography. Thesis and exhibition on documentary visual storytelling. Archival scanning and cataloging project. Eagle Scout.

Memberships: White House News Photographers Association (Associate Member, 2026), National Press Photographers Association, Professional Photographers of America.